

Funding proposal

For the establishment of the Global Water Investment Facility



From: [Stichting]

To: Aqua for All
Technical Assistance Support

The Netherlands, March 2026

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Executive Summary

Introduction

- This initiative to establish a Global Water Investment Facility (**'Facility'**) started as a strategic partnership that combines corporate leadership and basin-level priorities of the CEO Water Mandate's (**'CWM'**) Water Resilience Coalition (**'WRC'**) with Aqua for All's expertise on water investments and fund structuring.
- The objective of the partnership was to work towards the establishment of a Global Water Investment Facility with the ambition to invest corporate capital for positive water impact in the value chains of 100+ water-stressed basins, reaching 100 million people by 2027 and 300 million people by 2030. The global vehicle has a target size of USD [1-2] billion with an expected first close of USD [150-175] million by Q4 2026.
- The Government of Luxemburg (**'GoL'**) has committed EUR 500k for the development of the Facility: disbursement of EUR 250k in 2026 and 2027. An equivalent of matched funding is required.

Current situation

- This initiative is a non-core activity that was initiated within Aqua for All as a response to market demand.
- To allow for a more formal budgeting discipline for coverage of development efforts of the actual Facility, a new Stichting is being set-up as a separate entity to Aqua for All. The Stichting will act as an intermediate Facility with the intent to design the corporate water investment Facility that will be capitalised by a.o. CWM member corporates and other funders providing de-risking capital.
- This proposal is a request for EUR 500k grant funding from the Stichting to Aqua for All to match the funding provided by the GoL.
- For Aqua for All this is a unique strategic opportunity to:
 - Advance on its dual approach. When the Facility is established and funds are disbursed, Aqua for All will have played a unique, catalytic role resulting in 1) the mobilisation of private capital for the water sector from a new stakeholder group including corporate investors and 2) the deployment of private capital into selected regions within priority basins via a tailored investment vehicle, enabling targeted, scalable water investments.
 - In addition to contributing to SDG 6.1 and 6.2 (DGIS Water Results Framework, Results Area 1 (WASH)), which are themes that are also well covered as part of Aqua for All's overall strategic approach, the Facility will contribute to achieving SDG 6.4-6.6 on Water Management (DGIS Water Results Framework, Results Area 2, sub-results area 2.1 (IWRM, water efficiency in agriculture and water governance)).
 - Tapping into funding opportunities from corporate foundations beyond existing partners like Coca-Cola Foundation and Hilton Foundation, will become increasingly accessible.
- When the Facility becomes successful, the mobilisation and leverage effect will be exponential. With Aqua for All's EUR 500k contribution, the Facility is expected to mobilise USD 150–175 million at first close. Over time, the Facility aims to reach USD 1–2 billion.

Grant support requested

- Approve the proposed funding request of EUR 500k to Stichting, to be disbursed in 2026. This includes:
 - EUR 75k for Pacific Institute as WRC member coordinator (EUR 40k has been approved by Aqua for All MT in 2025, an addendum for the remaining EUR 35k will be presented to MT before end March).
 - EUR 311k for external advisors, including the project coordinator, fund advisor, investment advisor, strategic communications advisor.
 - EUR 55k for consultancy assignments (fund landscape analysis). The additional EUR 100k+ required for consultancies in 2026 will be covered by the GoL.
 - EUR 9k for design support.
 - EUR 50k in travel allowance for Aqua for All representatives and external advisors, as well as other project expenses.
- Approve additional EUR 182,400 in-kind contribution for 2026. This includes @4 days per month for the CEO, the Finance Lead and the wider Aqua for All team.
- The amounts presented are based on preliminary estimates and may be subject to adjustment.

1 Context and objective of the proposal

1.1 Introduction

The Stichting working in collaboration with the WRC and its members represents a visionary strategic partnership to mobilize corporate capital for transformative water impact. With a target size of USD 2 billion and the ambition to reach 100 million people by 2027 and 300 million people by 2030 across more than 100 water-stressed basins, the Facility will serve as a catalytic vehicle to channel private investment into scalable and viable solutions along water basin value chains.

1.2 Context, purpose and scope of the proposal

Context

In October 2024, Aqua for All was invited by WRC to present its strategic approach to investing in water solutions to advance SDG6. This triggered a co-creation process that led to the signing of a Memorandum of Understanding ('**MoU**') in November 2025 between Aqua for All and CWM and a Service Level Agreement ('**SLA**') between Aqua for All and Pacific Institute in November 2025. The goal of the strategic partnership with WRC and its members is to work towards the establishment and capitalization of a water investment Facility. See Annex 1 for an overview of process steps and background documents.

Purpose

As a non-core spin-off initiative, the newly established Stichting provides the formal structure for designing the Facility that will mobilize private capital from WRC members and other funders. Building on the initial interest from corporates and the formal contribution from the GoL for the establishment of the Facility, the Stichting is now seeking match funding from Aqua for All for the design and set-up of the Facility. This allows Aqua for All to continue to play a catalytic role in mobilising private capital and scaling targeted water investments in water basin value chains.

Scope

This proposal to Aqua for All is a component of wider efforts of the Stichting to work towards the establishment, first close and operational status of the Facility. Key building blocks include:

- **Feasibility trajectory**
 - **Corporate engagement and alignment:** Engage with corporates during workshops and 1:1 meetings to sensitise the Facility.
 - **Water value chain investment opportunity mapping:** Performance of a water value chain investment opportunity analysis linked to key sectors, key themes and key geographic areas based on priority basins. See RfP for the water value chain analysis in Annex 2.
 - **Investment opportunity mapping:** Performance of a market scan for a mock pipeline of funds and an illustrative investment portfolio. See Request for Proposals (RfP) for the fund landscape analysis in Annex 3.
 - **Investment opportunity selection and briefs:** Building on the investment pipelines and value chain analysis and basin mapping, develop a series of briefs identifying high-potential investment opportunities. Financial, strategic and impact return considerations inform the investment Facility design.

- **Facility structure analysis and design:** Working together with an independent fund advisor and legal firm (initial conversations have been with Allan & Overy) to perform an independent analysis of governance structures for the Facility, evaluating a range of instruments, tax suitability and jurisdictional analysis based on funder and investor goals, assess investor risk appetite and return objectives, jurisdictional analysis and ESG alignment to recommend the optimal structure.
- **Facility registration and implementation:** Development of formal documentation detailing the foundational elements of the Facility, including a full budget overview and cost breakdown, core vehicle design and structure, financial and strategic risk-return objectives, defined impact/result metrics, aligned as applicable with relevant ESG standards (e.g. SFDR Article) a mock investment pipeline, assessment of 2–3 potential domiciles for the Facility (e.g., the Netherlands, Luxembourg, or alternatives), evaluating regulatory, legal, and tax considerations relevant to both public funders and WRC member investors.

1.3 Key partners

Stichting

The Stichting team provides expert advisory on Facility architecture, the investment and impact strategy, and regulatory considerations regarding the establishment and operationalisation of the Facility:

- **Managing and executing the technical activities** related to the development of the Facility, and in mutual agreement with key stakeholders the management thereof (i.e. funder group, Steering Committee, working group).
- The technical activities carried out by the Stichting are not limited to, and will certainly include:
 - **Conduct feasibility studies**, fund landscape scoping, value chain mapping, financial modelling, legal structuring;
 - **Provide expert advisory** on water investment Facility architecture, investment strategy, and regulatory considerations;
 - **Initiate the structuring of the investment Facility** and undertake all preparatory measures deemed necessary for this purpose;
 - **Engage with partners to define the governance** regarding the development and implementation an Facility.
 - **Consolidating all findings** into an Investment Memorandum for the Facility.
- **Acting as the lead investment partner** and implementing manager of Facility, with the understanding to be formally mandated to manage the vehicle upon its establishment.

The CEO Water Mandate Water Resilience Coalition

The WRC is an industry-driven, CEO-led initiative to address the global water crisis. It is an initiative of the CWM between the UN Global Compact and the Pacific Institute. WRC's aim is to elevate action on mounting water stress and its connection to climate change to the top of the global corporate agenda. WRC members work to preserve the world's freshwater resources through collective action in water-stressed basins and through ambitious, quantifiable goals. In the initial stages of the Facility concept development, WRC and its members are actively engaged to commit to the Facility as frontrunners (anchor investors) and follow-on investors.

The Pacific Institute

Strategic and operational organization leadership for the WRC and CWM, coordinating implementation and reporting and signatory on behalf of the initiatives. In the initial stages of the Facility concept development, Pacific Institute has played a role to Facility workshops with WRC members and engage with WRC members to inform them about the Facility concept.

The Government of Luxembourg

The GoL has already demonstrated its confidence in this initiative with a EUR 500k commitment deployed in 2026 and 2027 toward development.

1.4 Aqua for All contribution and link with DGIS Water Results Framework

Aqua for All's mission is to mobilise private capital and strengthen enterprises to transform the water and sanitation sector in low- and middle-income countries. The strategic partnership between Aqua for All and WRC to establish a Global Water Investment Facility is seen as an opportunity to truly transform the water sector by demonstrating the effectiveness of structured, blended finance solutions and partnerships at scale. The Facility's focus on water basin value chains provides an opportunity for Aqua for All to also drive and direct investments in integrated water resource management and nature based solutions (SDG 6.4), while creating opportunities for businesses in these value chains. Aqua for All will play an important role in assuring the establishment of the Facility and catalyzing private sector investment in water basin value chains.

By providing a grant to this initiative, Aqua for All contributes to the following objectives:

- A systemic approach to transforming the water financing sector.
- Creation of impact opportunities at scale in water basin value chains including at enterprise and end-user level.
- Support the mobilisation of private (corporate) capital for the water industry, achieving leverage of up to [1: 8]. The leverage effect can be clarified once the investment strategy, including its geographic and thematic priorities, is defined in more detail, so an alignment can be made with Aqua for All's priority regions and SDG priorities.
- Directly supporting in the design and delivery of an investment-ready structure, i.e. bespoke Global Water Investment Facility.

Supporting the establishment of the Facility will be highly additional for Aqua for All. In addition to contributing to SDG 6.1 and 6.2 (DGIS Water Results Framework, Results Area 1 (WASH)), which are themes that are also well covered as part of Aqua for All's overall strategic approach, the Facility will contribute to achieving SDG 6.4-6.6 on Water Management (DGIS Water Results Framework, Results Area 2, sub-results area 2.1 (IWRM, water efficiency in agriculture and water governance)).

To match GoL support and ensure disciplined structuring of the Facility, the newly established Stichting seeks grant funding from Aqua for All to advance design, governance, as well as funder and investor engagement for establishing a bespoke water investment Facility, with a strong focus on both impact and returns.

1.5 Structure of the proposal

This proposal outlines the funding request to Aqua for All and the unique opportunity to leverage corporate leadership and blended finance to unlock exponential impact in global water resilience.

The proposal comprises the following sections:

[Section 1](#) in which the context and objective of the proposal are addressed.

[Section 2](#) in which the challenges and opportunities for financing the water sector are touched upon. This is considered an important perspective to provide so as to frame the involvement of private capital from global corporates.

[Section 3](#) where the structure and mechanism of the Facility is elaborated on.

[Section 4](#) covering the key milestones and approach to get to the establishment, first close and execution of the Facility.

[Section 5](#) in which the schedule, deliverables and workplan related to Aqua for All's grant funding are given.

[Section 6](#) provides more information on staffing and the governance structure.

[Section 7](#) where further details about the risks and mitigation measures are provided.

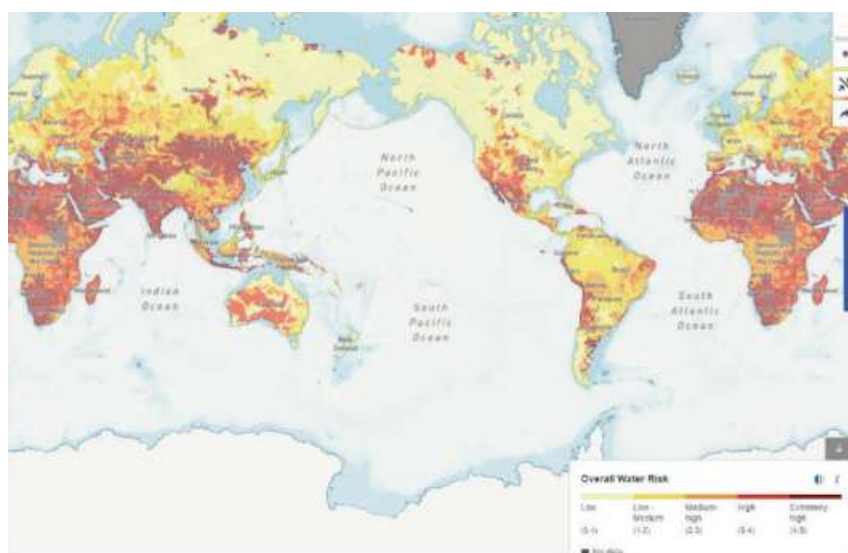
The proposal concludes with additional background information in the annexes.

2 Challenges and opportunities for the water sector

2.1 Water sector challenges and opportunities for investments and finance

Water insecurity has become a defining global risk multiplier. Today, 4 billion people face water scarcity, 2.1 billion people lack safe drinking water, and 3.4 billion people lack safely managed sanitation (World Bank, 2026). Climate change, urbanization, and industrialization are widening the demand–supply gap, with global demand projected to exceed supply by 40% by 2030 (UN, 2023). Financing is far below what is required: according to the World Bank (2026) annual spending gaps reach USD 141 billion for water supply and sanitation, while total global needs are estimated at USD 6.7 trillion by 2030 and USD 22.6 trillion by 2050. Public spending averages just 0.5% of GDP, and private investment remains marginal, underscoring the urgency of mobilizing new capital sources.

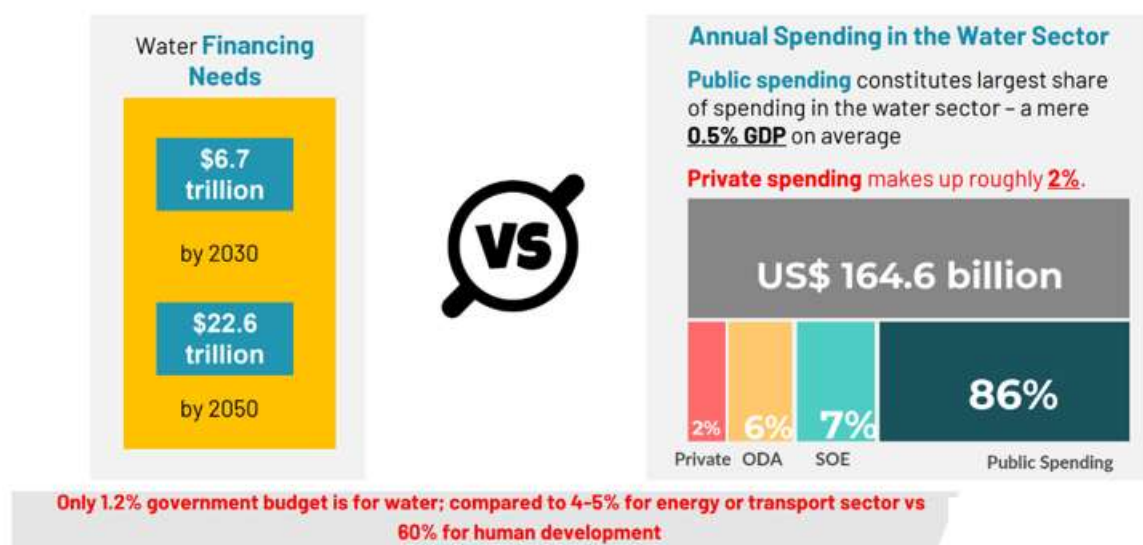
Figure 1 Water risk map



Source: Aqueduct, 2025

At the same time, water represents a resilient, non-substitutable asset class underpinning over 60% of global GDP (WWF, 2023). Policy and regulatory tailwinds—from the Paris Agreement to corporate disclosure frameworks—are accelerating flows toward water-positive investments. Opportunities are emerging through technology and innovation, including digital monitoring, desalination, and circular water systems, which offer scalable commercial potential. Business and their value chains are dependent on water for agriculture (e.g. food production), freshwater resources as inputs (e.g. beverage companies), and using water for their processes (e.g. data centers), making resilience investments essential for competitiveness. Such investments not only secure supply and reduce water access risks but also improve water quality, enhance productivity, monetize waste streams, and strengthen ESG performance. This offers impact opportunities in the water value chain from the direct business operations to the end-user level. Together, these challenges and opportunities create a compelling case for blended finance structures that de-risk investments and unlock private capital at scale, positioning water as a cornerstone of sustainable development and long-term economic stability.

Figure 2 Water sector financing gap



Source: World Bank, 2026

2.2 Lessons from other sectors

Globally, sectors such as energy, transport, and telecommunications have demonstrated clear trajectories toward investment readiness—moving from public-led financing to blended structures and ultimately attracting institutional capital. In energy, for example, early-stage public investments laid the groundwork for private participation through PPPs, credit guarantees, and regulatory reforms. Sovereign wealth funds, pension funds, and development finance institutions have since become key players, drawn by predictable returns and scalable models. Transport infrastructure followed a similar path, with governments and multilateral banks providing anchor capital and risk mitigation to crowd in private finance. These sectors show that public finance—whether through budget allocations, concessional loans, or guarantees—is not just a stopgap, but a strategic enabler of market development and investment maturity.

The water sector, particularly in sanitation, decentralized systems and water stewardship, is still early in this trajectory. Many projects lack the financial structure or scale to attract commercial capital, and social economic benefits—such as public health and environmental gains—are difficult to monetize. This is where a portfolio approach through a fund-of-funds structure becomes essential (WEF, 2024). By pooling capital and allocating it across specialized vehicles, such a structure can support projects at different stages of readiness: from early-stage innovation to growth-phase de-risking and large-scale infrastructure deployment. It allows public finance to play a catalytic role—absorbing early risk, demonstrating viability, and unlocking private flows. Moreover, it offers geographic and thematic diversification, helping investors manage exposure while accelerating impact. In short, a fund-of-funds approach mirrors the successful evolution of other sectors, providing the structure needed to move water from a public service gap to a resilient, investable asset class.

2.3 Emerging opportunities for corporate involvement

For companies, water security is no longer just a sustainability ambition, it is a strategic level for growth, resilience and competitive advantage. Companies that invest in water stewardship not only safeguard their operations but also unlock new growth opportunities and create long-term value, while contributing to a water-secure future for all. With the right solutions, it also presents a unique opportunity to accelerate innovation, develop smart water solutions and drive sustainable growth (CEO WM, 2023).

Among public and private stakeholders, water security is increasingly recognised as a cornerstone of human development and regional stability. For the private sector, this stability is foundational to resilient operations and sustainable growth. The rise in water-related tensions, with more than 280 conflicts documented since 2020, signals a growing source of instability with significant operational and supply-chain risks. Yet shared water resources present compelling opportunities to foster cooperation, attract investment, and build climate-resilient economies.

For corporate leaders, embracing water investing should be a means of risk mitigation but also a driver of long-term impact value creation. By supporting the establishment of the Facility, WRC members can support the transformation of the water sector at scale. This approach directly supports the corporate's core commitments, strengthens a company's social license to operate, and builds the environmental and economic resilience upon which business ultimately depends. In doing so, companies position themselves for sustained growth, innovation, and competitiveness in a future where water security is integral to business success and to the benefit of their consumers as well as the wider communities at large.

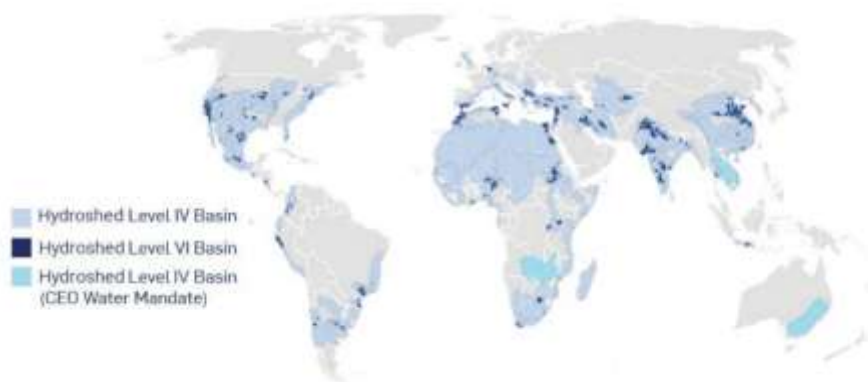
WRC members have identified 100+ Priority Basins where climate change, water stress, business risk, and social need intersect and where collective action is most urgent and impactful. In a world where usable water will become scarcer due to climate change, investing in better water management of key water basins, sustainable water use in value chains, water treatment, and provision of safe water and sanitation to communities, is essential. These basins support communities with access to clean water and sanitation services, local economies, and farms facing supply chain disruptions. Each priority basin represents an area of:

High water risk where scarcity or pollution threatens both communities and economies.

Shared responsibility where no stakeholder can make a difference alone.

Opportunities for resilience where solutions exist and can be scaled for positive impact.

Figure 3 Water stressed priority basins – overview of 100 priority basins



Source: CEO WM, 2023

2.4 Emerging opportunities for de-risking water sector investments

Public sector stakeholders have a pivotal role in shaping the investment landscape for water. Beyond providing concessional funding, governments and development finance institutions can deploy proven risk-mitigation instruments—such as first-loss capital, subordinated equity, guarantees, and political risk insurance—that shift the risk-return profile for private investors. These tools not only reduce exposure to early-stage risks but also create confidence in this market, where barriers are perceived as high.

A blended capital structure is central to our approach. By combining catalytic public finance with commercial capital, the Facility can accommodate diverse investor appetites. Public and philanthropic funders absorb early risks through subordinated tranches, while private investors provide senior capital with returns. This layered design ensures that also high-impact, climate-resilient water portfolios become investable at scale. Importantly, the structure can be tailored with dedicated sleeves—for example, innovation pilots, regional pipelines, or thematic priorities such as watershed restoration—allowing targeted de-risking where market gaps are most acute.

2.5 Conclusion

Water insecurity is both a global risk and a unique investment opportunity. While financing gaps remain vast, water is a resilient, non-substitutable asset class underpinning much of the global economy. Lessons from other sectors show that blended finance and fund-of-funds structures can accelerate investment readiness and unlock private capital at scale. For Aqua for All, this represents a strategic opportunity to play a catalytic role: supporting the design, governance, and de-risking mechanisms that will mobilize corporate capital into water basin value chains and scalable water solutions. By doing so, Aqua for All helps transform systemic challenges into investable opportunities—directly linking its support to the foreseen establishment of the Facility.

3 The Global Water Investment Facility

3.1 Vision and mission

The Stichting, with the support of WRC and its members, is addressing the global water financing challenge by combining corporate leadership and basin-level priorities with the Stichting's team expertise in water investments and fund structuring.

The objective of this initiative is to establish a Global Water Investment Facility with the ambition to invest corporate capital for positive water impact in the value chains of 100+ water-stressed basins, reaching 100 million people by 2027 and 300 million people by 2030. The Facility has a target size of USD 1-2 billion with an target first close of USD [150-175] million by Q4 2026.

3.2 Facility mechanics and guiding principles

The Facility will be designed as bespoke investment Facility where the capital flows from corporate investments to project realization. The focus of the Facility is on the one side to attract corporate investors into the Global Water Investment Facility, deploying its capital into funds that enable private sector projects focused on [water infrastructure](#), [natural capital](#), [financial institutions](#) and [enterprises](#) that have the goal to respond to and reduce water risks within assets, companies and their value chains. They are also expected to result in significant climate adaptation and resilience solutions, gender empowerment and economic development opportunities.

Figure 4 Global Water Investment Facility



Source: Stichting, 2026

The Facility is guided by the following principles:

- **Anchored in core and beyond:** Strengthen resilience within operations while scaling nexus solutions with systemic impact.
- **Transformational:** Unlock financial/economic value through strategic private sector water investments.
- **Commercially viable:** Ensure investments preserve economic capital, minimize losses.
- **Selective / Additional:** Target market gaps, starting with the challenge and integrating ESG and impact assessments aligned with global standards.
- **Speed:** Urgency demands rapid execution. Aggregation and programmatic approaches accelerate deployment.
- **Partnerships:** Collaboration is essential. We engage leaders and stakeholders across the resilient water finance space.

3.3 Diversification of the funder base

First tranche of seed capital secured: The Government of the Netherlands (GoN) has committed its support to the Facility during the launch of Making Water Count ('MWC') in Senegal. The GoL has committed EUR 500k seed capital to set up the Facility, disbursed in two tranches in 2026 – 2027. As detailed in this proposal the GoN through Aqua for All is requested to provide EUR 500k match funding to design and set-up the Facility. The WRC has initially committed for an amount of EUR 75k which is provided to Pacific Institute.

Investors in the vehicle: The first corporates have expressed willingness to invest USD [10-25] million in the Facility by end 2026. As per the diagram in Figure 5, corporate investments are expected to scale up rapidly. With the set-up of the water investment facility, we aim to attract investments from corporates, including but not limited to Reckitt, Ecolab, Danone, Grundfos, Diageo, AbInbev, Microsoft, Apple, Mars, Gap, which are the frontrunners of the CEO WM – WRC.

Figure 5 Pathway to achieving the overall \$2B investment target



Source: Stichting, 2026

3.4 Investing at scale

The overall goal of the Facility is to invest USD 1-2 billion in water and sanitation management reaching 100 million people by 2027 and 300 million people by 2030. The immediate pathway is envisioned as follows, amounts are indicative but will be firmed up during the engagement trajectory in 2026:

Corporate commitments pledged: The two WRC co-chairs (Reckitt and Ecolab) each commit USD [10-25] million in the Global Water Investment Facility by December 2026. [Eight] corporate frontrunners follow with investments of USD [10-12.5] million per corporate. At the UN Water Conference in the UAE (December 2026) a pledge of USD [150-175] million in the Global Corporate Investment Facility is announced.

First close: The target first close of the Global Corporate Investment Facility with an initial fund size of USD [150-175] million is January 2027. [The GoL is expected to provide EUR [5] million de-risking capital]. At WEF 2027 the first close of the Global Corporate Investment Facility is announced.

Deployment in funds: In 2027, USD [x] million will be deployed in [x] funds that are aligned with the Facility's investment and impact strategy. Investments will be ringfenced by geography / impact theme / sector. Investments with impact results plus financial return are prioritized. Further details can be provided based on the results from the fund landscape analysis including the pipeline and sample portfolio overview.

Projects supported: The average ticket size of investments by funds in underlying project portfolio is [x]. In 2027 [x] projects will be supported. Targeted impact results include: x people reached, x water quality, x water availability. Further details can be provided based on the results from the value chain analysis linked to the fund pipeline and sample portfolio overview.

The figures and amounts will be further specified and quantified during the coming months, using the inputs from the feasibility analyses.

3.5 Impact and ESG

Strategic impact objective

Demographic and economic growth are increasing the demand for water, in a variety of sectors including for example the agricultural sector that is using approximately 70% of globally available freshwater resources. At the same time, water security and flood safety are increasingly complex challenges that are aggravated by climate change (SDG 13). Moreover, water-related ecosystems are under increasing pressure and biodiversity is in decline. Addressing these interrelated challenges requires a significant amount of funding and finance as well as an integrated approach involving a variety of stakeholders, across sectoral and political boundaries.

By establishing a blended finance structure designed to unlock USD 1–2 billion in private capital, the Facility aims to strengthen sustainable, safe, and resilient water basin value chains. This includes promoting responsible freshwater withdrawals and supply to address water scarcity (SDG 6.4), advancing integrated water resources management (IWRM) at all levels—including transboundary cooperation (SDG 6.5)—and protecting and restoring water-related ecosystems (SDG 6.6). These efforts ultimately translate into improved access to clean drinking water and safe sanitation for basin communities (SDG 6.1 and 6.2), while also generating economic opportunities for enterprises and creating jobs (SDG 8) and equity benefits (SDG 5).

SDG Impact objectives

The Facility will focus its contribution to the following SDG impact objectives:

- Contribute to SDG 6.1, namely that by 2030, universal and equitable access to safe and affordable drinking water is achieved for all.
- Contribute to SDG 6.2, namely that by 2030, access to adequate and equitable sanitation and hygiene is achieved for all.

- Contribute to SDG 6.4, namely that by 2030, water-use efficiency is increased across all sectors and sustainable withdrawals and supply of freshwater is ensured, to address water scarcity and substantially reduce the number of people suffering from water scarcity.
- Contribute to SDG 6.5, namely that by 2030, integrated water resource management (IWRM) is implemented at all levels.
- Contribute to SDG 6.6, namely that by 2020, water-related ecosystems, including mountains, forests, wetlands, rivers, aquifers and lakes, are protected and restored.
- Contribute to SDG 13, namely to take urgent action to climate change and its impact and more specifically SDG 13.1 to strengthen resilience and adaptive capacity to climate-related hazards and natural disasters in all countries

Impact pathway

The Stichting begins by engaging corporate partners to align priorities and reduce barriers to investment. Through market scans and water value chain analyses, it identifies a diversified pipeline of opportunities across water basin value chains. These analyses are distilled into investment briefs, which provide actionable insights for investors by balancing financial returns with strategic and impact objectives.

With a blended finance structure, public and philanthropic capital absorbs early-stage risks, while corporate and private investors provide senior capital. This anticipated layered design makes high-impact water portfolios investable at scale. The Facility's governance and ESG requirements further build investor confidence.

As private capital flows into funds that invest in water basin value chain related initiatives, this ultimately leads to improving access to safe water and sanitation, strengthening agricultural water efficiency, restoring ecosystems, and enhancing resilience in water-stressed basins. Over time, this catalyzes a systemic shift: water transitions from an underfunded public good to a resilient, investable asset class.

By 2030, the Facility aims to have mobilized USD 1–2 billion, reaching 300 million people, while embedding corporate engagement as a cornerstone of global water resilience.

The impact pathway and corresponding Theory of Change (ToC) will be further detailed during the (pre) feasibility and design phase of the Facility and is expected to be finalised end June 2026.

Impact targets

The Facility strives to contribute to the following impact targets:

- The overall goal of the Facility is to invest USD 1-2 billion in water and sanitation management reaching 100 million people by 2027 and 300 million people by 2030.

The underlying methodology including risks and assumptions based on which the targets are set will be further detailed during the (pre) feasibility and design phase of the Facility (March – December 2026).

Impact indicators

In collaboration with the anchor investors, the Stichting will agree on key performance indicators monitored over the lifetime of the Facility:

Table 1 Key performance indicators (indicative)

	Key Performance Indicators (Indicative) Monitored over the life of the Facility	Year 1*	Yr N
1.	Total investments made (# and USD)		
2.	Cumulative amounts mobilised (USD)		
3.	Funds (investees) supported in target countries (#)		
4.	Investments made classified as climate resilient (#)		
5.	People reached with climate resilient water services (#), disaggregated by gender		
6.	Improved water quantity and quality		
7.	Increased water availability		
8.	Companies that have conducted a (physical) climate risk assessment (#)		
9.	Financial indicators, including IRR, Profitability, Portfolio outstanding, NPLs		
10.	Number of investees that are 2X aligned		
11.	Number of investments in Nature-based Solutions		
*	<i>Targets to be further refined based on capital structure</i>		

It is the intention to assess impact at the basin level in line with the Technical Guide for Net Positive Water Impact, developed by the CWM (2024). This will be done through external third-party impact reviews.

Targeted geographies, sectors, themes, basin value chains

The **targeted geographies** will be anchored around the 100 water stressed basins globally (Figure 3), zooming in on 24 high priority basins (Figure 6) that were presented by WRC at the WEF (2026). During the feasibility phase, maximum allocation thresholds per geography will be developed.

Figure 6 - 24 Priority basins



Source: Stichting, 2026

The anchor investors and corporate frontrunners are active in **five priority sectors**: consumer goods, textiles, agriculture, water, and technology. Taking these sectors as the basis, an analysis of water stressed basin linked value chain investment opportunities, that provides a clear overview of the scale of investment opportunities per sector as well as the project pipeline for funds, will be performed during the (pre) feasibility and design phase of the Facility and is expected to be finalised end June 2026. See Annex 2 for the RfP Water basin value chain analysis.

The water investments extend past core business premises to catalyze solutions across nexus sectors — water, food, energy, industry, and circular economy. In addition to the spill-over effects on nexus sectors, the investment opportunities will focus on **four thematic areas**: water infrastructure, nature-based solutions, MFI/FI WASH portfolios, and enterprises/ventures. During the (pre) feasibility and design phase of the Facility, a link will be made between the outputs of the value chain investment opportunity analysis with the results of a fund landscape analysis (Annex 3 RfP Fund Landscape Overview). See Table 2 for a sample overview of sectoral investment and impact opportunities in the water basin value chains. Together, this will inform the strategy impact investment approach of the Facility that will invest in water through private funds.

Table 2 Water basin value chain related investment opportunities / business models (impression)

Sector	Water basin value chain Investment opportunities / Business models	Financial viability	Impact potential	Link with fund portfolios
Consumer Goods	• Circular packaging • Refill and reuse models • Water-efficient manufacturing processes	• Cost savings from reduced water and energy use	• Reduced water abstraction and wastewater discharge • Lower plastic leakage into waterways	• Circular economy and impact consumer goods
Textiles	• Low-water dyeing; wastewater recycling and treatment • Sustainable fiber production	• Reduced treatment costs • Improved resilience to water scarcity	• Reduction in water pollution • Improved water basin health	• Sustainable apparel • Industrial water treatment

Agriculture	• Precision irrigation • Soil moisture sensing • Climate smart inputs • Water-efficient post-harvest solutions	• Higher yields and input efficiency • Reduced water and energy costs	• Reduced water withdrawals • Improved groundwater recharge • Lower nutrient runoff	• Agri-tech • Climate-smart agriculture and food systems
Water	• Utility partnerships through service contracts/co-investment • Fecal sludge management	• Reduced capex • Operational cost efficiencies	• Improved water quality • Reduced groundwater/surface water contamination	• WASH-focused investment vehicles • Infrastructure and utility investments
Tech	• Water-efficient cooling • Rainwater capture • AI driven water management	• Reduced operational costs • Lower risk of supply disruptions	• Improved water resilience • Minimized freshwater use	• Climate-resilient infrastructure • Water stewardship-linked investments

Source: Stichting, 2026

All together, this approach positions companies not only as resilient operators but also as drivers of systemic transformation in the entire water value chain.

Our impact and ESG measurement and management system

The Facility's impact measurement and management ('IMM') system is designed to operate across multiple layers of investment, reflecting its fund-of-funds structure. At the portfolio level, the system tracks how capital is allocated into underlying funds, ensuring that each fund adheres to agreed impact standards and contributes to outcomes in the water basin value chain. At the fund level, managers are required to integrate the Facility's core indicators and cross-cutting themes (gender, climate, systemic sustainability) into their own monitoring frameworks. This layered approach ensures consistency while allowing flexibility for funds to adapt to local contexts and sectoral priorities.

Measurement is structured around outputs, outcomes, and impacts. Outputs include increased water quantity, water quality and water access. Outcomes capture systemic changes such as strengthened water and sanitation ecosystems, and enhanced resilience in priority basins, with basin-level results benchmarked using tools such as the Net Positive Water Impact Technical Guide (CEO Water Mandate, 2024). Long-term impacts are assessed against SDG 6 and related goals. By embedding IMM into fund selection, due diligence, and reporting, the Facility ensures that impact is not an afterthought but a core investment criterion.

The IMM system also incorporates mobilisation and leverage tracking, a critical dimension for a fund-of-funds model. By monitoring how catalytic capital unlocks private flows, the Facility can demonstrate additionality and systemic value creation. Reporting is harmonised across funds, with consolidated dashboards that aggregate results at Facility level while maintaining transparency at fund level. Continuous learning loops enable adaptive management, ensuring that insights from one fund inform strategies across the portfolio. In this way, the IMM system transforms the fund-of-funds structure into a platform for scaling impact, accountability, and resilience across diverse geographies and investment themes.

The Facility's IMM system will be guided by the Operating Principles for Impact Management, the integration of an ESG Policy aligned to the IFC Performance Principles, 2X Gender Criteria, Climate

Standards and SFDR alignment as applicable. The Facility's IMM system including an impact strategy, policies, guidelines and standards will be further detailed during the (pre) feasibility and design phase of the Facility (March – December 2026).

4 Approach and key milestones

4.1 Approach

The operationalisation of the Facility will follow a phased approach designed to progressively build investor and funder confidence, align corporate priorities with investment opportunities, and establish a robust governance and financial structure.

Phase 1: Feasibility (September 2025 – June 2026)

This phase focuses on corporate engagement, investor alignment, and (pre-)feasibility analyses. Through workshops and interactions at major global convenings (UN Climate Week New York, WEF Davos, WB Spring Meetings Washington D.C.), the team will introduce the Facility concept, secure early input from WRC members, and map corporate investment priorities in water value chains against investment opportunities through funds. Pre-feasibility work will assess the fund landscape, value chain opportunities, and legal/governance options, culminating in soft commitments from frontrunner corporates and public funders.

Phase 2: Development (June 2026 – December 2026)

Building on Phase 1 outputs, this phase will formalize the Facility structure and investment strategy. Activities include detailed water basin value chain mapping, preparation of investment briefs, formal incorporation of the Stichting and its governance structure, and independent analysis of Facility structures and domiciles. A recommended Facility plan will be produced, including budget, governance, risk-return objectives, impact and ESG alignment, and a mock investment pipeline. Validation workshops with anchor investors at Climate Week London and UN Climate Week New York will secure commitments, leading to the preparation of the Investment Memorandum.

Phase 3: Operationalisation and Execution (January 2027 and beyond)

The Facility will be launched publicly at WEF Davos 2027, following the initial announcement of the first close at the UN Water Conference in December 2026. From this point, the Facility will execute investments into funds targeting climate-resilient water projects, leveraging its blended capital structure to mobilize corporate and institutional investors at scale. Continuous monitoring of impact metrics and governance oversight will ensure alignment with investor expectations and global ESG standards.

4.2 Key milestones

To work towards the operationalisation of the Facility, the team has identified three key phases:

Phase 1: Feasibility (September '25 – June '26)

Phase 2: Development (June '26 – December '26)

Phase 3: Operationalisation and execution (January '27 and beyond)

The grant funding requested from Aqua for All serves the first two, overlapping, phases. Key milestones include, but are not limited to:

Phase 1a October '25 – April '26: Corporate engagement and investor alignment

This phase will seek input from companies to determine aligned criteria for a bespoke investment Facility that will address corporate risk/return, impact and legal requirements.

September 2025: UN Climate Week (in-person workshop #1 with all WRC members)

Introduction of Facility concept to WRC members and service agreement with Pacific Institute.

November 2025: Virtual workshop #1 with all WRC members (# 40 corporates).

Re-introduction of Facility concept and engagement of the corporates.

January 2026: WEF Davos (in-person meetings with a selection of WRC members).

High-level corporate engagement and formal support from GoL announced.

January 2026: MWC launch Senegal (announcement of partnership with WRC members).

Public announcement of investment Facility concept.

February 2026: Virtual workshop #2 with WRC members ('leaders' and 'learners').

Introduction to investment opportunity pipeline (high-level overview).

March-June 2026: Pre-Feasibility analysis.

Fund landscape – investment opportunity pipeline.

Value chain analysis – investment priorities identification.

Legal structure – governance structure and design.

April 2026: Working Group and Steering Group meetings and workshop #3 with WRC members).

Soft commitments of frontrunners to support the Facility.

Phase 1b April '26 – September '26: Facility design and development

In this phase the Facility structure will be formalized and the terms will be detailed, including a term sheet, investment and impact strategy, Investment Memorandum, financial model.

April-June 2026: Feasibility analysis.

Corporate-basin investment priority mapping: Building on the value chain analysis identified in Phase 1a, develop a detailed mapping of the frontrunners' key investment priorities against the WRC's 100 priority water basins. This exercise provides a clear understanding of the investment opportunity.

Investment opportunity selection and briefs: Building on the fund investment pipelines identified in Phase 1a, a series of briefs identifying high-potential investment opportunities based on value chain analysis and basin mapping will be made. Financial, strategic and impact return considerations inform the funds of choice.

Governance structure implemented: Stichting incorporated.

Facility structure analysis: An independent study of investment Facility structures, evaluating a range of instruments, tax suitability and jurisdictional analysis based on corporate goals, assess investor risk appetite and return objectives, jurisdictional analysis and ESG alignment to recommend the optimal Facility structure.

Recommended Facility plan: Development of documentation detailing the foundational elements of the proposed Facility:

- A full budget overview and cost breakdown;
- Facility design and structure;
- Financial and strategic risk-return objectives;
- Defined impact/result metrics, aligned with SFDR Articles 8 or 9 (or any other relevant ESG standards);
- A mock investment pipeline;
- Assessment of 2–3 potential domiciles for the Facility (e.g., the Netherlands, Luxembourg, or alternatives), evaluating regulatory, legal, and tax considerations relevant to both corporate investors and WRC members.

Phase 2 June '26 – December '26 and beyond: Implementation of the Facility

This output of Phase 1 will serve as a key validation step toward the development of the Private Placement Memorandum (PPM) in Phase 2.

June 2026: Climate Week London.

Validation of investment opportunities and priorities with potential anchor investors.

September 2026: UN Climate week New York.

Confirmation anchor investor and other commitments to investment Facility.

December 2026: UN water conference UAE.

First close and initial corporate investments into the investment Facility.

January 2027: WEF Davos.

Public announcement of the investment Facility.

5 Budget, activities and deliverables

5.1 Budget

- The total estimated budget required for the set-up of the Facility in 2025, 2026 and 2027 is EUR [2 million].
 - This amount includes the SLA amount agreed between Aqua for All and Pacific Institute in 2025, but excludes the additional activities performed by Pacific Institute.
 - WRC has initially committed an amount of EUR 75k which is provided to Pacific Institute.
- The budget requested by the Stichting to Aqua for All is EUR 500k for specific elements during the feasibility and development phase of the Facility in 2025 and 2026:
 - EUR 75k for Pacific Institute as WRC member coordinator.
 - EUR 311k for external advisors, including the project coordinator, fund advisor, investment advisor, strategic communications advisor.
 - EUR 55k for consultancy assignments (fund landscape analysis). The additional EUR 100k+ required for consultancies in 2026 will be covered by the GoL.
 - EUR 9k for design support.
 - EUR 50k in travel allowance for Aqua for All representatives and external advisors , as well as other project expenses.
- The expected in-kind contribution from the Aqua for All team is estimated at EUR 182,400 in 2026. This includes @4 days per month for the CEO, the Finance Lead and the wider team.
- The GoL has provided a total of EUR 500k, disbursed in two tranches in 2026 and 2027.
- The remainder of the funding estimated at EUR 850k for the establishment of the Facility in 2026 and the initial operational stage in 2027 is to be provided by other funders.

A comprehensive overview of the budget (indicative) is provided in Annex IV Budget.

5.2 Activities and deliverables

The activities and deliverables related to the Aqua for All grant component will focus on the following elements:

1. **Project coordination and support:** Provide expert coordination and stakeholder management support.
2. **WRC member engagement:** Working together with Pacific Institute to facilitate workshops and direct engagement with WRC members to align corporate priorities and secure early commitments.
3. **Investment opportunity and selection briefs with a focus on the fund landscape analysis:** Conduct a comprehensive market scan to identify potential funds and build a mock investment pipeline.
4. **Expert advisory for investment Facility design and capital structure:** Provide expert advisory support to shape the Facility's investment and impact strategy, governance, communications and outreach to funders and investors.
5. **Registration investment Facility and resource mobilization:** Establishment and operational report, Business Plan, Policy House, and appointment of the fund administrator.
6. **Operational expenses including design support and travel:** Deliver professional design outputs for reports, presentations, and branding to ensure clarity and visibility of the Facility concept. Enable participation in global convenings and in-person meetings with corporates and funders to advance engagement and secure commitments.

The budget provided by the GoL will be primarily used to pay for legal costs related to Facility structure and design, Facility registration and implementation, external consultancy assignments (e.g. value chain analysis – deep dive).

Table 3 Activities, deliverables, budget and timeline (indicative overview)*

Activities and Deliverables	Total Budget (GoL + A4A) 2026 (EUR)	Luxemburg contribution as part of total (EUR)	Aqua for All contribution as part of total (EUR)	Timeline
1. Project coordination and expert advisory	90k		90k	2025/2026
2. Corporate engagement and value chain mapping of priority basins by Pacific Institute Activities - Market scan of corporate investment priorities and criteria Deliverables • Workshop coordination • Engagement plan • Overview of corporate investment priorities and criteria	55k 75k	NA	75k	Q1/2 2026
3. Investment opportunity selection and briefs Activities - Term sheet (indicative), developed by expert advisors and key persons (GoL) - Value chain analysis (GoL) - Market scan for mock pipeline and illustrative investment portfolio of private funds, developed with support of a private-market consultant (A4A) — Roadshow AfA to engage corporates Deliverables • Term sheet (indicative)	120k 135k	20k 60k 80k	55k	Q1/2 2026

• Landscape of private funds and investment themes • Face-to-face engagements between key persons with corporate frontrunners (- #8)				
4. Investment Facility design and capital structure (deep dive)* Activities - Review and selection of optimal place of domiciliation for the fund, with expert advisors (A4A) - Legal advisor support re governance structure by Allen & Overy (GoL) - Financial model of the fund, developed by a private-market consultant - Deep dives by key persons and expert advisors: - Review operational funding instruments from other sectors - Assess governance structures - Evaluate multiple funding instruments on their contribution to relevant frameworks such as SDGs, water and nexus impact themes - Investment and impact strategy development - Description of performance assessment and risk management mechanisms - Potential investor/LP segmentation (i.e. longlist) - Design optimal capital structure - Legal verification of capital structure - Document findings and prepare workshop materials for WRC Deliverables • Document with fund design and capital structure, i.e. Information Memorandum	200k	[A&O] 30k 110k	90k	Q1/2 2026

- Financial model - Investment and impact strategy - Presentation of findings through workshop				
5. Registration investment Facility and resource mobilisation Activities - Approval fund design (organizational and institutional) - Business plan for the management of the fund including governance, developed by the key persons and expert advisors - Short- and medium-term operational and implementation plan - Policy house, developed by the key persons and expert advisors - Finalise a ranked list of investors (i.e. shortlist), with key persons and expert advisors - Legal guidance for establishment and registration of fund, with expert and legal advisors Deliverables • Establishment and operational report • Business Plan • Policy house • Appointment fund administrator	200k	60k	140k	Q2/3 2026
6. First and initial closings Activities - Legal documentation, with external experts and legal advisor support - Roadshow, market access and onboarding investors - Investment promotion at conferences, especially targeting the private sector	150k	150k	NA	Q4 2026 - Q1/2 2027

- Marketing and communications material, including website, teaser, slide deck Deliverables - Partnership agreement draft (i.e. LPA) - Data room set up - Fund established and first close				
7. Organisational expenses for Aqua for All staff and expert advisors including travel and design costs	50k		50k	
7. 'Contingency' costs (remaining budget for year 2 will be provided in September 2026)	100k	100k		
Total	825k	500k	500k	

* The amounts are indicative. The items that are striked through were the original amounts included in the grant funding proposal to GoL.

5.3 Payment schedule

[Insert suggested payment schedule]

6 Governance structure

6.1 Governance framework – feasibility and design phase

During the feasibility and design phase of the Facility three committees / working groups will guide to establishment of the Facility:

1. The Funder Committee

The Funder Committee consists of senior representatives from the Funders including the GoL and catalytic funders like Aqua for All. The Funder Committee will meet every 6 months (April and October).

2. The Steering Committee (SteerCo)

The SteerCo will provide strategic direction, ultimate oversight, and final approval for the Facility. This body is responsible for ensuring the initiative remains aligned with its core mandate and has the resources and commitment needed for success.

- **Composition:**

- Senior Leadership from the Stichting (Josien Sluijs) and the WRC (Jason Morrison).
- Three leadership representatives from the WRC frontrunners including the WRC co-chairs.

- **Key responsibilities:**

- **Set strategic direction:** Confirm the Facility's overall vision, scope, and investment and impact mandate.
- **Provide final approval:** Act as the final decision-making authority on key milestones, major deliverables, and "go/no-go" transition points between phases.
- **Resolve critical issues:** Serve as the primary escalation point for strategic roadblocks or resource conflicts that cannot be resolved by the Working Group.
- **Champion the initiative:** Collectively champion the project within their respective organizations and to external stakeholders to secure buy-in and support.

3. The Working Group

The Working Group is the engine during the establishment of the Facility, responsible for the day-to-day execution, analysis, and preparation of all deliverables. This team will manage the operational cadence and ensure the project stays on track.

- **Composition:**

- Operational leads from the Stichting (Aarno Keijzer, Ingwell Kuil) and WRC (Cheryl Hicks, Ian Hoyt).
- Designated representatives and subject matter experts from WRC member companies.
- Technical experts and advisors from any third-party consultants that may be hired who will be asked on a case-by-case basis to provide input to the specific topics.

- **Key responsibilities:**

- **Execute the workplan:** Drive the day-to-day activities outlined in the workplan, managing timelines and coordinating tasks.
- **Conduct analysis and prepare deliverables:** Perform all required analysis (market, financial, value chain) and prepare all deliverables for SteerCo review and approval.
- **Identify and mitigate risks:** Maintain a risk register, conduct ongoing risk assessment, and implement mitigation strategies for operational challenges.

- **Ensure information flow:** Facilitate seamless communication and information sharing among all team members and prepare regular progress reports for the SteerCo.

This structure ensures that strategy guides execution and execution informs strategy.

- **Cadence:** The **Steering Committee** will convene monthly to review progress and make key decisions. The **Working Group** will meet fortnightly to drive execution and resolve operational issues. The **Funder Group** will meet every 6 months in April and October.
- **Decision path:** Issues will first be addressed within the Working Group. If a resolution requires strategic guidance, a change in scope, or impacts budget/timeline, it will be formally escalated to the Steering Committee with a clear recommendation.

Figure 7 Governance structure Facility establishment phase



Source: Stichting, 2026

6.2 Governance principles

The Facility will balance strategic oversight, fiduciary responsibility, and operational agility. Its governance framework ensures accountability to investors, alignment with the WRC members missions, and compliance with international best practices in impact investing. The governance framework for the Facility will be guided by a set of governance principles:

- The facility is being designed with a comprehensive governance structure. This will be informed by the advice from [Allen & Overy], a Senior expert on Fund Advisory, and in close cooperation with the Funder and Steering Committees.
- As part of the facility structure and aligned to the transaction process, committees will be put in place:
 - Investment Committee (pre transaction approval).
 - Portfolio and Risk Committee (post transaction approval).
- Incentives will be aligned with fund performance, ESG and impact criteria.

- An independent Risk and Compliance body will be overseeing performance, risk exposure and alignment with diversification limits.
- Quarterly reporting and audited financials will be planned for.
- Independent Reviews and verifications will be planned for, to assess both the facility, as well as transactions.
- Active communication about successes and lessons learnt will be performed.

6.3 Expert advisors

External advisors have been selected based on their expert roles advising Aqua for All. Bios of key people and consultants are provided in annex 1. The selection of external consultants to deliver the assignments will be done through a competitive procurement process, aligned with AfA's procurement policy.

Investment Fund Risk and Operations, Ms Tanja Pelle. A highly accomplished and transformative investment strategist with over 20 years of expertise in investment banking and private equity. Tanja has an outstanding track record of success across both developed and emerging markets, demonstrating her global influence and strategic insight. She is renowned for her innovative approach to financial risk management and fund design, having pioneered scalable financial vehicles such as the ILX Fund—an SDG-focused global emerging markets credit fund with approximately \$2 billion in assets under management. As Chief Financial and Risk Officer until July 2025, she crafted the fund's growth, resilience, and risk mitigation with vision and resilient leadership. Tanja's forward-thinking approach, relentless professionalism, and commitment to sustainable investment empowered her to drive meaningful change and foster industry-wide innovation.

Investment Committee member and Fund Investment Advisor, Mr Mark van Doesburgh. An inspiring leader and expert in fund structuring and corporate finance, he has over 30 years' experience in investment management and banking. Co-founder of Triple Jump Investment Management in 2006, he has led and advised its debt, equity, advisory, and impact teams. He specialises in structuring funds in frontier and emerging markets and serves on boards of investment funds and financial institutions.

Project coordinator and Strategic Finance and Impact advisor, Mrs Ingwell Kuil. An accomplished leader in international development, innovative financial risk management and nature and climate finance. She brings nearly 20 years of professional experience across DFIs, multilateral development banks, and private investment funds in a variety of sectors. She is a Director at Rebel Advisory East Africa, a strategic and financial advisory firm. She has a proven track record of designing and structuring financial instruments, developing impact management strategies, and driving climate and gender initiatives at both corporate and project levels. She has demonstrated a strong ability to take projects from concept through to implementation—transforming ideas into investable solutions—involved in the design of funds and programmes from concept to implementation in complex international settings and driving measurable finance, impact and ESG results in development finance.

7 Risks and mitigation measures

7.1 Risks related to Facility establishment

Besides the opportunities, there are risks linked to the establishment and implementation of the Facility. Table 4 provides an overview of the risks, the likelihood that the risks occurs, mitigation measures and the severity of the consequences in case a risk materialises. During the pre-feasibility and design phase of the Facility a risk and mitigation matrix will be developed that applies to the operational and execution phase of the Facility. Risks then include investment risk, operational risk, commercial risk, financial risk, impact and ESG risk, political risk, environmental risk.

Table 4 Overview of risks and mitigation measures

Risk category	Specification	Likelihood (1 = low, 4 = high)	Mitigation measures	Severity	Notes
Contextual preconditions and risks	Governance structure not adequately used during establishment phase → delays in decision-making	2	Lead on establishment of governance structure. Organize committee and workgroup meetings with clear agendas and timelines.	High	Weak governance could undermine credibility and slow implementation
Market readiness	No appetite to invest or fund a fund-of-funds structure	2	Build evidence through demonstration portfolios. Share best practice case studies with investors.	High	Lack of investor appetite could stall the establishment of the Facility
Market readiness	Pipeline of funds insufficient to meet investor criteria (geographic scope, impact, return)	2	Commission BFinance to conduct market assessment scan by June. Expand pipeline development to include diverse geographies and sectors.	High	Insufficient pipeline reduces attractiveness to investors
Stakeholder engagement	Misalignment between funders' de-risking capital and corporate investor priorities	2	Develop clear investment and impact strategy. Allocate percentages to target geographies, sectors, themes, and basin value chains.	High	Misalignment could weaken blended finance effectiveness
Pathway logic	Corporate investors prefer direct supply chain links in basins	2	• Educate investors on water value chain opportunities (RfP analysis).	Medium	Could reduce corporate participation if not addressed

			Highlight indirect benefits through fund-of-funds		
Pathway logic	Quantitative impact in basins using fund-of-funds structure cannot be adequately estimated	2	Develop impact hypothesis, assumptions and estimates. Agree impact and ESG KPIs with funders	High	Weak measurement undermines credibility and investor confidence
Pathway logic	Emphasis on mobilisation compromises impact and ESG	2	Balance mobilisation targets with ESG commitments. Establish monitoring framework to track both capital and impact.	High	Risk of reputational damage if impact and ESG is diluted
Reputational	Insufficient appetite for the Facility and unfavorable feasibility analysis → stakeholders question initiators	1	Highlight Government of Luxembourg's EUR 500k commitment. Communicate feasibility findings transparently.	High	Could damage trust and credibility with stakeholders

Source: Stichting, 2026

Annexes

Annex I	Process steps and background documents
Annex II	RfP value chain analysis
Annex III	RfP fund landscape analysis
Annex IV	Budget

Annex I Process steps and background documents

Date	Process Steps	Link to supporting document*
October 30 2024	Workshop CEO WM (WRC) joined by JS and AK	Workshop CEO WM October 2024 Meeting notes .docx
July 10 2025	Concept note and workplan for joint programme with Pacific Institute presented to MT	Concept note - CEO Water Mandate - draft.docx
August 15 2025	Concept note, workplan, budget, MoU shared with Pacific Institute (draft) and slide deck shared with CEO WM (WRC)	Fw Global Water Investment Facility initiative - deck + budget.msg
September 21 2025	Concept note, MoU (draft) and slide deck shared with CEO WM (WRC). Final draft concept note shared with WRC co-chairs (Reckitt and Ecolab).	RE Simplified MoU for NYC. Re Memorandum of Understanding CEO Water Mandate Aqua for All.msg
September 24 2025	Announcement of partnership with CEO WM (WRC) at UN Climate Week in NYC	4.1 UN Climate Week NYC Sept 2025
November 12 2025	MoU, SLA with Pacific Institute approved by MT	Email / MT minutes
November 17 2025	MoU, SLA (final) signed with Pacific Institute	Final SLA and annexes
October /November 2026	Outreach on proposed programme to NL govt, Government of Luxemburg, EBRD, World Bank, GCF, GIZ, SDC, UN	8 Outreach
December 12 2026	Funding proposal submitted to Government of Luxemburg	A4A Lux proposal CEO WM - v.02 pdf.docx
December 29 2026	Funding proposal approved by Government of Luxemburg	Email/call
January 20 2026	WEF Davos: partnership announced with CEO WM (WRC) at Executive Roundtable. Support from Government of Luxemburg announced.	4.3 WEF Davos January 2026
January 26 2026	UN water conference Dakar: partnership with CEO WM and support from government of Luxemburg announced. Press release issued.	4.4. UN Senegal January 2026
February 12 2026	Workshop CEO WM (WRC) for leaders and learners on investment options	4.5 Workshop February 12 2026
February 13 2026	Draft funding contract received from Government of Luxemburg	202602 Grant Agreement - Aqua for All v.1.docx
February 25 2026	MT/RvT meeting/decision to establish a 'project stichting' for the programme	Minutes meeting MT / RvT
March x 2026	Proposal submitted to Aqua for All	
March x 2026	Approval of PDD in Aqua for All IC/MT	
March x 2026	Funding contract signed with Government of Luxemburg	

Request for Proposals

Title: Water Investment Facility – Value chain analysis

Summary

Organisation	Name new Stichting
Focus of the assignment	Water related investment priorities and opportunities linked to 100 water stressed basins globally, zooming in on 24 high priority basins across 5 sectors and 4 thematic areas
Duration of the assignment	6 weeks
Proposal deadline date	[March 16, 2026]
Assignment start date	[March 25, 2026]
Contact details	Aarno Keijzer, Investment Director

Introduction

To meet SDG6, the world will need more than one trillion dollars every year to deliver sustainable water management globally. Right now, the bulk of spending comes from the public sector—about 0.5% of GDP on average. Private spending, by contrast, makes up only around 2%. That imbalance highlights both the reliance on public budgets and the untapped potential of private capital, including from corporates.

[insert name new Stichting] is an impact organization committed to crowd in private capital and strengthen enterprises to transform the water and sanitation sector. We believe that market based scalable solutions, combined with public and private capital are needed to bridge the gap to achieve SDG 6 – water and sanitation for all.

In line with its strategic direction to work with a variety of partners to secure water for all, strategic partnerships have been formed with a.o. the Water Resilience Coalition (WRC), bringing together corporate leadership and basin-level priorities of the WRC with the specialised, water-focused technical, advisory and financial expertise of [insert name new Stichting].

The WRC has established a clear and ambitious agenda: to achieve a positive water impact in over 100 water-stressed basins and improve access for over 300 million people by 2030. Achieving this scale of impact requires moving beyond operational water stewardship to catalysing new streams of capital. It also requires partnerships and tools that can cater for this opportunity. Key targeted impact results are linked to water availability, water quality and water accessibility.

Purpose of the assignment

The purpose of this assignment is to conduct an analysis of water stressed basin linked value chain investment opportunities that provides a clear overview of the scale of investment opportunities and project pipeline for funds.

Currently, a fund landscape overview is conducted. The consultant will be asked to link the outputs of this fund landscape analysis to the results of the value chain investment opportunities. Together, this will inform the investment narrative and strategy of a possible investment vehicle that will invest in water through private funds.

Value chain analysis and basin mapping

To enable the design of portfolios suitable for fund investment, a value chain analysis is required to identify water-related business models and investable projects across:

- 100 water stressed basins globally, zooming in on 24 high priority basins
- Four thematic areas: water infrastructure, nature-based solutions, MFI/FI WASH portfolios, and enterprises/ventures.
- Five priority sectors: consumer goods, textiles, agriculture, water, and technology.

Investment narrative and strategy

Building on the identified pipeline of funds (which is done as a separate assignment and is expected to be finalised mid April, 2026) and based on the value chain analysis and basin mapping, an investment narrative and strategy of a possible investment vehicle that will invest in water through private funds needs to be written.

Investment opportunity briefs

A series of briefs identifying high-potential investment opportunities need to be developed. Financial and strategic impact risk and return considerations need to be taken into account.

The outcome of the analysis and briefs will support the investment and impact strategy of the global water investment facility. Corporates require this information for their decision making process to commit their capital to the facility.

Scope of work

The consultancy firm will:

- Value chain analysis: Conduct a comprehensive (qualitative and quantitative) review of water value chains linked to 100 water stressed basins globally, zooming in on 24 high priority basins and map investable opportunities along four themes and five sectors. The objective is to create a well-organized quantitative and qualitative overview that covers:
 - Analysis of water value chains linked to 100 water stressed basins globally, zooming in on 24 priority basins
 - Analysis of the corporates involved including their investment financing needs (direct operations, along their value chain, at end-user level)

- Based on the sectors the corporates are active in, analysis of the water value chain per sector and landscape of financially viable business models and financially viable projects, including a quantitative estimate of the potential investment opportunity (long-term, medium-term, short-term) based on the demand (per sector and per theme) and any sector barriers/or risks for commercial finance.
- Estimate of the overall market size for fund investments linked to 100 water stressed basins globally, zooming in on 24 priority basin value chains.
- Expected impacts as per impact criteria including but not limited to water quality, availability, accessibility.
- Validation of analysis results with corporate frontrunners.
- An investment narrative and strategy of a possible investment vehicle that will invest in water through private funds.
- Identification and analysis of real-world case studies and business models to be included in investment opportunity briefs.

The results will be used to inform decision-making on the opportunities for private funds to invest in with the objective to achieve positive water impact linked to the 100 water stressed basins, zooming in on 24 priority basin value chains.

Key deliverables and timelines

Deliverables and outputs	Timeline (2026)
Kick-off meeting	[March 25]
Inception report	[April 2]
First draft overview	[April 24]
Review meeting	[May 6]
Final report and presentation	[May 20]

Duration and reporting

The assignment will be conducted within 6 weeks from contract signing with an expected LoE of [30] consultancy days. The assignment is expected to start [March 25, 2026, and end May 20, 2026]. The consultant will report to Aarno Keijzer, Investment Director through bi-weekly check-ins for the remainder of the project.

Qualifications of the consulting firm / consultant

The service provider should demonstrate a proven track record in conducting market analyses across both global and emerging-market water basins and their value chains, with specific experience identifying financially viable business models across the identified sectors and themes, and alignment with corporate investment priorities.

Proposal format and evaluation criteria

Proposals should be submitted in word (pdf) and not exceed 10 pages, excluding annexes. The budget should be provided in Euros. Aqua for All is [say something about VAT and all applicable taxes].

The proposal should include the following elements that will be evaluated on an equal basis:

- Clear understanding of the assignment and methodological approach
- Experience with similar assessments and familiarity with the global water sector
- Team composition and expert knowledge

Deadline for submission, timeframe and target dates

The submission deadline for the proposal is [March 16, 2026, noon] [EU time].

Milestone	Timeframe (2026)
RfP published	[March 5, 2026]
Submission of proposals	[March 16, 2026]
Review of proposals	[March 16-19, 2026]
Proposal agreement and contracting	[March 20-24, 2026]
Contract start date	[March 25, 2026]

Remuneration

The payment structure will be based on milestone table above and the below structure will be followed;

- 10% upon the signing of the contract by all parties.
- 30% upon presentation of the Inception report.
- 30% after completion, submission, and acceptance of the draft report and investment opportunity briefs.
- 30% after completion, submission, and acceptance of the final report and investment opportunity briefs.

Submission details

Proposals should be sent to: a.keijzer@aquaforall.org.

Request for Proposals

Title: Water Investment Facility – Private funds market search

Summary

Organisation	Aqua for All
Focus of the assignment	Private funds market search
Duration of the assignment	6 weeks
Proposal deadline date	January 23, 2026
Assignment start date	February 6, 2026
Contact details	Aarno Keijzer, Investment Director

Introduction

Aqua for All is an impact organization committed to crowd in private capital and strengthen enterprises to transform the water and sanitation sector in low and middle-income countries. We believe that market based scalable solutions, combined with public and private capital are needed to bridge the gap to achieve SDG 6 – water and sanitation for all.

In line with its strategic direction to work with a variety of partners to secure water for all, Aqua for All has formed a strategic partnership with the Water Resilience Coalition (WRC), bringing together corporate leadership and basin-level priorities of the WRC with the specialised, water-focused technical, advisory and financial expertise of Aqua for All.

The WRC has established a clear and ambitious agenda: to achieve a positive water impact in over 100 water-stressed basins and improve access for over 300 million people by 2030.

Achieving this scale of impact requires moving beyond operational water stewardship to catalysing new streams of capital. It also requires partnerships and tools that can cater for this opportunity.

Purpose of the assignment

The purpose of this assignment is to conduct a targeted market search of private-markets funds—including private equity, private debt, mezzanine, venture, and blended-finance vehicles—whose strategies, investment focus, and instruments align with the investment priorities typically expressed by corporate partners.

In addition, the assignment will include a benchmarking component using publicly listed investment vehicles such as Exchange-Traded Funds (ETFs) and thematic mutual funds that target similar sectors and themes. This comparative analysis will provide insights into relative performance, and risk-return profiles, supporting informed decision-making and portfolio design. The outcome will support future partnership development and the matching of corporate investment interests with suitable private-market investment vehicles.

The assignment aims to:

- Identify private-markets funds operating in sectors and themes relevant to corporate investment interests (water management, forestry, land management, food systems, agriculture, textile manufacturing).
- Map private-markets funds by:
 - Geographic activity (global focus)
 - Private-markets investment strategy (PE, PD, venture, infrastructure, real assets)
 - Preferred instruments (equity, debt, mezzanine)

- Ticket sizes and fund size
- Impact focus and measurement approach
- Risk/return profile, management fees and liquidity characteristics
- Assess the suitability of private-markets funds for potential collaboration or co-investment.
- Develop a shortlist of private-markets funds that best align with identified corporate investment priorities.
- Propose indicative portfolio structures for a fund-of-fund investment vehicle consisting of private-market funds.
- Benchmark private-market funds against listed funds (ETFs and thematic funds) by collecting key attributes such as fund name, ticker, thematic focus, AUM, historical performance, and comparing risk/return characteristics, impact relevance, and scalability.

Scope of work

The consultant will:

- Carry out desk research and database research to identify relevant private-market funds across suitable markets.
- Collect key data on fund structure, governance, thematic focus, performance (where available), pipeline relevance, impact methodology and fund-level reporting indicators.
- Produce a comparative overview highlighting differences, strengths, and opportunities.
- Identify high-potential private funds for further engagement.

Deliverables include:

- Longlist of private-market funds with key attributes, based on assigned research profiles, such as minimum fund size, return expectations, investment strategy, and ESG scores.
- Comparative overview summarizing strategies, geographies, instruments, fund size, and impact relevance.
- Shortlist of recommended private markets funds with rationale.
- Mock portfolio structures, including indicative allocation, strategy, return and risk estimations.
- Final summary report synthesising findings and outlining next steps.

The results will be used to inform decision-making on which private funds are best positioned to match corporate investment priorities and support future strategic engagement.

Key deliverables and timelines

Deliverables and outputs	Timeline (2026)
Kick-off meeting	February 10
Inception report	February 20
First draft overview	March 16
Review meeting	March 19
Final report and presentation	March 25

Duration and reporting

The assignment will be conducted within 6 weeks from contract signing. The assignment is expected to start February 2, 2026, and end March 13, 2026. The consultant will report to Aarno Keijzer, Investment Director through bi-weekly check-ins for the remainder of the project.

Qualifications of the consulting firm / consultant

The service provider should demonstrate a proven track record in conducting market searches across both global and emerging-market private-market funds, with specific experience identifying water-focused investment funds, water-themed general partners (GPs), or closely related thematic strategies (e.g., climate adaptation, nature-based solutions, sustainable infrastructure, WASH-aligned private-markets vehicles, water management, forestry, land management, food systems, agriculture, textile manufacturing). This includes experience assessing fund manager capabilities, performance history, thematic relevance, and alignment with corporate investment priorities.

Proposal format and evaluation criteria

Proposals should be submitted in word (pdf) and not exceed 10 pages, excluding annexes. The budget should be provided in Euros. Aqua for All is [say something about VAT and all applicable taxes].

The proposal should include the following elements that will be evaluated on an equal basis:

- Clear understanding of the assignment and methodological approach
- Experience with similar assessments and familiarity with the global water sector
- Team composition and expert knowledge

Deadline for submission, timeframe and target dates

The submission deadline for the proposal is January 23, 2026, noon [EU time].

Milestone	Timeframe (2026)
RfP published	January 12, 2026
Submission of proposals	January 23, 2026
Review of proposals	January 26-30, 2026
Proposal agreement and contracting	February 2-6, 2026
Contract start date	February 6, 2026

Submission details

Proposals should be sent to: a.keijzer@aquaforall.org.

Annex IV Budget

The budget is a living document, detailed in Section 5 of the proposal. Table 2 outlines the activities and costs to be covered by Aqua for All. A dynamic Excel template is provided separately.

Budget Item	Unit Costs (€) unit		2026	2027
Remuneration				
GWIF team				
Senior team member - 2026	8,000	salary	48,000	
Senior team member - 2027	8,000	salary		96,000
Medior team member - 2026	6,000	salary	36,000	
Medior team member - 2027	6,000	salary		72,000
Junior team member - 2026	3,500	salary	21,000	
Junior team member - 2027	3,500	salary		42,000
GWIF team	EUR	315,000	105,000	210,000
A4A team				
A4A team (in kind contribution)	EUR	364,800	182,400	182,400
Expert Advisors				
Expert Advisors	EUR	621,600	310,800	310,800
Pacific Institute				
Pacific Institute	EUR	150,000	75,000	75,000
Legal				
Legal	EUR	300,000	300,000	-
Marketing / branding				
Marketing / branding	EUR	18,000	9,000	9,000
Expenses				
Travel costs				
Travel costs	EUR	70,000	35,000	35,000
Other				
Other expenses	EUR	-	-	-
Consultancy				
Assignments				
Consultancy Assignments	EUR	160,000	160,000	-
Other costs				
Back-office				
Admin	EUR	-	-	-
Other				
Other costs	EUR	-	-	-
Total Budget				
Remuneration				
GWIF team	EUR	315,000	105,000	210,000
A4A team (in kind contribution)	EUR	364,800	182,400	182,400
Expert Advisors	EUR	621,600	310,800	310,800
Pacific Institute	EUR	150,000	75,000	75,000
Legal	EUR	300,000	300,000	-
Marketing / branding	EUR	18,000	9,000	9,000
Total Remuneration	EUR	1,769,400	982,200	787,200
Consultancy Firms				
Consultancy Assignments	EUR	160,000	160,000	-
Other costs				
Travel costs	EUR	70,000	35,000	35,000
Other expenses	EUR	-	-	-
Admin	EUR	-	-	-
Other costs	EUR	-	-	-
Total Other costs	EUR	70,000	35,000	35,000
Total Budget (indicative)	EUR	1,999,400	1,177,200	822,200

Budget & Funding

The funding provided by the GoL and Pacific Institute (in-kind), together with the requested funding from Aqua for All covers 48.8% (2026) and 69.9% (2027) of the funding needs for the establishment of the Facility. Note that the funding needed for the establishment also includes anticipated staff time for team members to be hired.

Budget & Funding					
Global Water Investment Facility					
Budget Item	Unit Costs (€)	unit	comments	2026	2027
Luxembourg	EUR	500,000		250,000	250,000
Aqua for All	EUR	500,000		250,000	250,000
[new funder]	EUR	-			
[new funder]	EUR	-			
[new funder]	EUR	-			
Sub Total	EUR	1,000,000		500,000	500,000
Pacific Institute	EUR	150,000		75,000	75,000
Pacific Institute	EUR	150,000	<i>in-kind (non-ca</i>	75,000	75,000
Total Funding (Committed)	EUR	1,150,000		575,000	575,000
Budget versus Funding					
Total Budget (indicative)	EUR	1,999,400	- #	1,177,200	822,200 - -
Total Funding (Committed)	EUR	1,150,000	- #	575,000	575,000 - -
Budget Deficit	EUR	(849,400)		(602,200)	(247,200)
% of Budget funded	%	57.5 %		48.8 %	69.9 %

Disclaimer

This document is a draft proposal. It does not create binding obligations and may be revised.